

New Hire Therapist Orientation Checklist

Complete for every new PT, OT, or ST · Staff and travelers · 2026

Therapist Name:		Discipline:	☐ PT ☐ OT ☐ ST
Start Date:		Staff or Traveler:	☐ Staff ☐ Traveler
Building:		DOR:	

1. Access & Setup — Day 1

	Task	Date Completed	DOR Initials
☐	NetHealth login credentials obtained and tested — can log in and navigate		
☐	PointClickCare (PCC) login confirmed — can access patient charts		
☐	TheraDocs AI introduced — www.theradocai.com — web-based AI documentation assistant, no setup required		
☐	Building tour completed — therapy gym, patient rooms, supply storage, emergency exits		
☐	Introduced to therapy team — all PTs, OTs, STs, and rehab aides		
☐	Introduced to facility administrator, DON, and MDS coordinator		
☐	Parking, badge access, and facility entry procedures confirmed		

2. Compliance & Documentation — Day 1–2

	Task	Date Completed	DOR Initials
☐	Physician order requirement explained — never treat without a signed order		
☐	Documentation standards reviewed — skilled need language, goal format		
☐	8-Minute Rule and CPT code guide reviewed (available in Therascope Resources tab)		
☐	Group vs concurrent therapy requirements and documentation explained		
☐	Frequency justification expectations reviewed — individualized, not protocol-based		

3. Clinical Onboarding — Day 2–3

	Task	Date Completed	DOR Initials
☐	Active caseload reviewed with DOR — patient introductions completed		
☐	Physician orders verified for all assigned patients		
☐	Payer status confirmed for all assigned patients (Part A, Part B, managed care)		
☐	Existing goals reviewed — therapist understands each patient's plan of care		
☐	Weight-bearing status, precautions, and isolation protocols reviewed for all patients		
☐	Restorative nursing program reviewed — knows which patients are transitioning		

New Hire Therapist Orientation Checklist

Complete for every new PT, OT, or ST · Staff and travelers · 2026

	Task	Date Completed	DOR Initials
☐	Shadowed experienced therapist or DOR for first session (if new to SNF setting)		
☐	Adaptive equipment locations identified — walkers, wheelchairs, gait belts, transfer belts		

4. Performance Expectations — Week 1

	Task	Date Completed	DOR Initials
☐	Productivity goal explained — building-specific target confirmed with DOR		
☐	Cost Per Minute (CPM) explained — how their billing efficiency contributes to CPM		
☐	Units Per Visit (UPV) expectations reviewed — target 3.0+ units per visit		
☐	Documentation turnaround expectations confirmed — same-day preferred		
☐	Scheduling expectations explained — patient coverage, communication on absences		
☐	Regular check-in schedule with DOR established		

5. Tools Quick Reference

Tool	What It's Used For	Access
NetHealth	All therapy documentation and billing — notes, evals, goals, charges	Login from DOR
PointClickCare	Physician orders, MDS, nursing notes, care plans, patient demographics	Login from DOR
TheraDocs AI	AI documentation assistant — SOAP notes, goal language, skilled need phrasing	www.theradocai.com

Sign-Off

☐	Orientation complete — therapist has reviewed all sections and is ready for independent caseload		
☐	Therapist has read and acknowledged the DOR Playbook orientation materials in Therascope		

Therapist Signature:	_____	Date:	_____
DOR Signature:	_____	Date:	_____